Material Handling Equipment

Category: **Retail, Logistics & Warehouse** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 7 labs

Covers these lab items: Goods moving equipments; Material Handling Equipment; MHE

What it is used for

Material handling equipment helps lift, move, store, or position goods safely in workplaces. Correct equipment selection, load control, and safe movement reduce injuries and damage to materials.

Main parts

- Frame or platform supports the load during movement.
- Wheels or rollers allow equipment to move across suitable surfaces.
- Handle or steering control guides the equipment.
- Lifting mechanism raises loads on applicable equipment.
- Brakes or locking devices prevent unintended movement.
- Controls and switches operate powered equipment where fitted.
- Load rating label identifies the permitted working capacity.

Before you start

1. Identify the load weight, size, shape, and handling requirements.
2. Choose equipment rated for the load and suitable for the floor and route.
3. Inspect wheels, handles, forks, brakes, lifting parts, controls, and frame for damage.
4. Check that load rating labels are readable and the rated capacity is sufficient.
5. Clear the travel route of obstacles, spills, and people.
6. Wear suitable footwear and other task-specific PPE before handling goods.

How to use

1. Position the equipment close to the load on stable ground.
2. Secure the equipment against movement before loading or adjusting it.
3. Place the load evenly and keep it within the rated capacity.
4. Use straps, restraints, or guards when required to prevent load shifting.
5. Raise or lower loads using the designated controls and approved method.
6. Move at a controlled speed and maintain a clear view of the route.
7. Use assistance when the load blocks visibility or requires team handling.
8. Park on a level surface and apply brakes or locking devices where fitted.
9. Lower lifting parts fully and remove the load using a safe method.
10. Return the equipment to its designated storage area and report any defects.

⚠ Safety

- Never exceed the rated capacity or carry unstable loads without securing them.
- Keep hands and feet away from wheels, rollers, forks, and moving mechanisms.
- Never stand beneath a raised load or allow people into the danger zone.
- Do not ride on equipment unless it is specifically designed for passengers.
- Use correct lifting technique and team assistance for heavy or awkward items.
- Stop using equipment with defective brakes, damaged parts, or unstable movement.

Care & storage

- Clean equipment after use and remove debris from wheels and moving parts.
- Inspect handles, wheels, brakes, lifting mechanisms, and restraints regularly.
- Store equipment in a dry, designated area without blocking emergency exits.
- Arrange authorised maintenance and report defects before returning equipment to service.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using equipment whose capacity is lower than the load weight.
- Moving goods without securing them against slipping or falling.
- Pushing equipment through cluttered routes or at excessive speed.
- Ignoring damaged wheels, brakes, handles, or lifting mechanisms.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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